title: "Equality Diversity Human Rights Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Equality, Diversity & Human Rights Policy

Policy Title: Equality, Diversity & Human Rights

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – e.g. one year later]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, residents, contractors, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

[INSERT CARE HOME NAME] is committed to ensuring that equality, diversity, and human rights are fully embedded into the culture and practices of our care service. We believe every person has the right to be treated fairly, with dignity and respect, regardless of age, disability, gender, race, religion, belief, sexual orientation, gender reassignment, or socio-economic background.

We will ensure that:

- All residents and staff are treated equally and fairly
- Services are accessible, inclusive, and person-centred
- Discrimination, harassment, and victimisation are not tolerated

2. Legal Framework

This policy is based on the following legislation and standards:

- Equality Act 2010
- Human Rights Act 1998
- Care Act 2014
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities Regulations) 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 10: Dignity and Respect

3. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Promote a culture of inclusion and fairness
- Ensure services are delivered in a way that respects people's rights
- Comply with legal and regulatory requirements
- Support staff to challenge discrimination and uphold best practice

4. Protected Characteristics

Under the Equality Act 2010, discrimination is unlawful based on any of the following protected characteristics:

- Age
- Disability
- Gender reassignment
- Marriage and civil partnership
- Pregnancy and maternity
- Race (including colour, nationality, ethnic or national origin)
- Religion or belief
- Sex
- Sexual orientation

5. Commitment to Residents

We will ensure that:

- All residents receive care tailored to their personal needs and preferences
- Residents are supported to express their identity, beliefs, and lifestyle
- Cultural, religious, dietary, and language needs are respected
- Residents are protected from all forms of discrimination and abuse
- Care plans reflect each person's individual identity and background

6. Commitment to Staff

We will ensure that:

- Recruitment, selection, and promotion are based on merit
- Staff have equal access to training and development
- A diverse workforce is valued and supported
- Staff are free from bullying, harassment, or victimisation
- Any concerns about discrimination or inequality are taken seriously and investigated promptly

7. Human Rights Approach

We adopt a Human Rights-Based Approach (HRBA) to care and support. This means we uphold the following rights for residents and staff:

- Right to be treated with dignity and respect
- Right to privacy and confidentiality
- Right to autonomy and choice
- Right to freedom of expression, belief, and religion
- Right to protection from inhuman or degrading treatment

8. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures this policy is implemented and reviewed
- Provides training and support to staff
- Investigates and responds to any complaints of discrimination

All Staff:

- Uphold the values of equality, diversity, and inclusion
- Challenge discrimination or unfair treatment
- Complete relevant training and apply it in practice

9. Training and Awareness

- Equality, Diversity & Human Rights training is part of staff induction
- Refresher training is provided annually
- Staff are encouraged to reflect on unconscious bias and inclusive practice

10. Complaints and Reporting

- Discrimination or breaches of this policy will be treated as misconduct
- Residents, staff, or visitors may raise concerns through:
    - The Complaints Policy
    - Whistleblowing Policy
    - Speaking directly to the Registered Manager

11. Monitoring and Review

- This policy is reviewed annually or after significant changes in legislation
- Equality outcomes will be monitored through audits, feedback, and incident reporting
- Action plans may be developed to improve equality and inclusion in the home

12. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Whistleblowing Policy
- Complaints Policy
- Recruitment and Selection Policy
- Data Protection and Confidentiality Policy
- Code of Conduct

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